

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



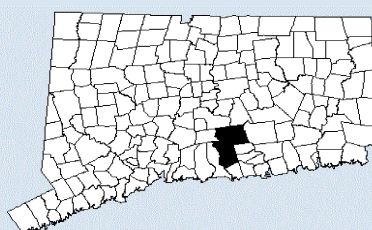
Regional School District 17

Jeffrey Wihbey, Superintendent • 860-345-4534 • <https://www.rsd17.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	6
Enrollment	1,770
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$24,145
Total Expenditures ¹	\$44,209,516

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	908	51.3	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	33	1.9	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	85	4.8	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	52	2.9	4.7
White	1,578	89.2	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	15	0.8	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	253	14.3	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	307	17.3	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	54	6.4	14	1.6
Male	59	6.7	60	6.4
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	6	6.9	*	*
White	95	6.2	64	4.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	37	14.0	11	3.7
Students with Disabilities	36	12.1	28	7.7
District	113	6.6	74	4.1
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 95

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	138.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	9.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	24.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	58.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.0
School Level	8.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	4.0
Support Staff	2.5
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	7.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	15.0
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	113.4

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	1	0.5	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	1.5	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	202	98.1	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.4	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	*	*
White	77	67.5	115	97.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	11	*	15	*
Students with Disabilities	9	*	12	*
District	86	67.2	130	97.7
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	16	44.4
Emotional Disability	21	72.4
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	90	89.1
Other Health Impairment	63	90.0
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	39	100.0
District	232	79.5
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	39	2.2	2.6
Emotional Disability	29	1.7	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	101	5.8	6.4
Other Health Impairment	71	4.1	3.5
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	53	3.0	2.0
All Disabilities	311	17.9	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	7	2.3	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	11	3.5	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$23,755,200	\$12,974	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$3,510,014	\$1,948	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,701,336	\$944	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$488,543	\$271	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$2,149,072	\$1,193	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$3,333,237	\$1,850	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$5,837,457	\$3,239	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$3,434,657	\$1,855	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$44,209,516	\$24,145	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$2,910,060	28.7	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,470,121	14.5	10.2
Other Salaries	\$237,268	2.3	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,322,337	13.0	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$808,473	8.0	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,499,958	24.6	22.2
Supplies	\$24,449	0.2	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$871,326	8.6	8.4
Equipment	\$6,397	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$2,070	0.0	0.1
Total	\$10,152,458	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	86.4
State	12.0
Federal	1.5
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	14	*	14	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	46	75.4	46	71.8	19	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	32	68.2	32	66.0	12	*
White	817	72.3	816	70.5	330	73.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	14	*	14	*	7	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	906	72.6	905	70.6	364	73.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	122	66.8	121	66.1	46	66.9
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	798	73.2	798	71.0	325	74.7
Students with Disabilities	166	53.0	165	51.0	57	54.1
Students without Disabilities	754	76.7	754	74.6	314	77.3
High Needs	256	59.8	255	58.1	91	61.6
Non-High Needs	664	77.3	664	75.1	280	77.7
District	920	72.4	919	70.4	371	73.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	90.8	90.7	89.2	96.0	507	91.7
Curl Up	95.0	89.1	97.3	93.6	506	93.7
Push Up	94.3	79.8	67.6	92.8	505	84.4
Mile Run/PACER	92.2	82.2	73.9	72.0	506	80.6
All Tests - District	82.6	64.3	55.9	71.2	503	69.2
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	144	94.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	19	*
Students with Disabilities	35	91.4
District	155	94.8
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	89	73.6
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	*
White	143	61.6
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	11	37.9
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	160	61.3
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	92.1	93.5
Male	78.1	88.2
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	N/A	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	84.8	90.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	72.7	*
District	85.2	91.2
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	72.4	75	48.3	50	96.5	63.9
	High Needs Students	59.8	75	39.9	50	79.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	70.4	75	46.9	50	93.9	60.2
	High Needs Students	58.1	75	38.7	50	77.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	73.8	75	49.2	50	98.4	61.8
	High Needs Students	61.6	75	41.1	50	82.2	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	49.3%	100%	49.3	100	49.3	58.7%
	High Needs Students	41.1%	100%	41.1	100	41.1	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	64.9%	100%	64.9	100	64.9	61.4%
	High Needs Students	58.3%	100%	58.3	100	58.3	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	6.6%	<=5%	46.9	50	93.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	11.8%	<=5%	36.5	50	73.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	82.8%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	61.3%	75%	40.9	50	81.7	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		97.7%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		94.8%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		96.2%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		85.2%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		98.2% 69.2%	75%	46.1	50	92.2	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		68.8%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1097.9	1350	81.3	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.8	15.2	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.1	16.9	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.6	13.4	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	96.2%	0.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	96.0
Math	All Students	98.5
	High Needs Students	95.6
Science	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	95.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 64.4

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Regional School District 17 continues the use of building-based Continuous Improvement Plans with measurable goals and action steps in academic achievement, family engagement, and school climate aligned to the District's Strategic Operating Plan, Vision of the Graduate and District Mission and Vision. Common planning time and data team structures are provided for all teaching staff in PreK-12 to ensure data-driven planning and instruction. Our data process and protocols were refined this year and more time was devoted to data team reflection, collaboration, and planning at the grade, school and district levels. Through various funding sources, a professional development plan, overseen by the PDEC committee, is in place to align with the District Continuous Improvement Plan, and feedback from staff is analyzed. The district continues to support professional development opportunities for staff including the Science of Reading, Building Thinking Classrooms in Mathematics, the Marzano's New Art and Science of Teaching, and school climate. Curricula are aligned with applicable national and state frameworks for instruction and are being updated through a cyclical process overseen by the District Curriculum Council. The district maintains a comprehensive coaching and intervention structure to assist in the areas of language arts and mathematics. MTSS systems and structures are implemented district-wide to ensure students' individual needs are met including benchmark screening assessments, tiers of intervention for behavior, SEL and academic concerns, progress monitoring and frequent communication with families. Student Services reflected on past practices and received a program review from a consulting group. They continue to focus on increasing the inclusion of disabled students with non-disabled students and have implemented formal pre-referral models at all schools. Ongoing collaboration between regular education and special education staff continues to support new initiatives in the areas of teaching and learning. In addition, we continue to partner with Effective School Solution clinicians at all levels to support students with intensive SEL mental health needs. The RSD17 Summer Learning Website is updated annually to provide math and ELA opportunities for parents to support their children at home in the summer. Jumpstart summer sessions were held for incoming kindergarten and middle school students to ease the transition into Kindergarten and Middle School. Families are viewed as essential partners and included in a variety of meetings, assemblies, and evening events throughout the school year. Educators involve families in their child(s) education, ensure consistent communication, and include information about progress and growth opportunities. The RSD17 Vision of the Graduate and Instructional Vision continue to influence our Continuous Improvement Plans, curriculum updates, and professional learning plan. The Vision clarifies and unifies our goals for students. These traits have always been essential, and we imagine a future where all students are prepared to provide leadership, creativity, and ingenuity in an increasingly connected global world. Our Instructional Vision is based on the instructional core framework that emphasizes the interrelatedness of the teacher, the student and the curriculum around a task.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Regional School District 17 is committed to an inclusive educational experience for all students and to expanding students' opportunities to interact with the diverse global community. We intentionally plan, design and initiate various cultural awareness experiences to broaden student perspectives about the world. A multitude of classroom and assembly-based programs continue to be incorporated on an annual basis. Our curricular approach provides experiences that teach and promote acceptance and kindness, and an understanding that everyone has a story. Diverse texts are integrated into the ELA and Social Studies curriculum K-12 in order to offer students "windows and mirrors" into diverse cultural backgrounds. In the past the middle School teachers participated in Restorative Practices professional learning in order to strengthen relationships, build social relationships within communities, and repair harm. The High School partnered with NCCJ in order to provide programming related to social justice, social identity, and reducing bias, bullying, oppression, and discrimination. Topics related to social justice, equity, bullying, harassment, and acceptance are taught through our Tier 1 research-based SEL curriculum, Second Steps (K-8) and School Connect (9-12). DESSA was used as a universal screener in K-8 and data has been used to confirm, add and revise supports for students. Our High School offered the new Black and Latino Studies elective course and experienced full enrollment. The Seal of Biliteracy is promoted and awarded to students that meet the requirements. Opportunities for secondary students to complete coursework at local colleges and universities continue to support the efforts of the district to include HK students in more culturally diverse learning environments. A committee of educators and administrators developed a plan for Increasing Educator Diversity in alignment with state requirements including action steps for recruiting, hiring and maintaining diverse educators.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Regional School District 17 appreciates the support of the communities of Haddam and Killingworth. It continues to be the practice of the Region 17 schools administration and the Board of Education to ensure equitable allocation of all of the district's financial resources in a manner that meets the needs of all students. The budget development process begins in early November of each year, with building administrators and department supervisors submitting budget requests to the district's central administration. These requests are reviewed in conjunction with the District's Strategic Operation Plan, Vision of the Graduate, state and national requirements, and clearly stated objectives for the next school year. Various data points are considered to ensure that requested funding aligns with planned district initiatives and needs. Considerable efforts continue to allow the district to use financial strategies such as cooperative purchasing, re-appropriation of existing resources, and a district-wide commitment to economic efficiency has resulted in effective outcomes.